

Bulgaria May Trip - Itinerary, Food, Budget

Test document for TripMind AI RAG upload. This file is fictional but realistic and designed for retrieval tests.

Three-day draft itinerary

Day 1: Explore central Sofia. Start with Alexander Nevsky Cathedral, walk through the city center, see Serdica ruins, visit St. George Rotunda, and finish around Vitosha Boulevard. If there is energy, add a sunset walk near National Palace of Culture.

Day 2: Take a day trip to Rila Monastery. This is the most reliable cultural highlight outside Sofia. If using a tour, check if it includes Boyana Church or another nearby stop.

Day 3: Choose Plovdiv for architecture and atmosphere, or Vitosha Mountain for nature. Plovdiv is better for history and photos; Vitosha is better if the traveller wants hiking and views.

Food to try

- Banitsa - pastry with cheese, good for breakfast.
- Shopska salad - tomato, cucumber, onion, peppers, and sirene cheese.
- Kebapche - grilled minced meat, simple and filling.
- Tarator - cold yogurt and cucumber soup, refreshing in warm weather.
- Mekitsa - fried dough, often eaten sweet or with cheese.
- Bulgarian yogurt - worth trying because Bulgaria is famous for it.

Budget notes

For a budget traveller, Sofia can be manageable if staying in a hostel or simple apartment and using public transport. Food costs can stay low with bakeries, local restaurants, and supermarkets. Tours to Rila Monastery or Seven Rila Lakes are likely the biggest daily expense.

Approximate planning assumptions

A normal budget day in Sofia can include cheap breakfast, public transport, one museum/church ticket, and casual dinner. A day tour may increase the daily cost significantly but can save stress and time. Plovdiv as an independent day trip may be cheaper than a mountain tour.

Best answer for limited time

If the traveller asks for the best places from these files, recommend Sofia center, Rila Monastery, Plovdiv, Vitosha Mountain, Boyana Church, and Seven Rila Lakes. Explain that Rila Monastery and Plovdiv are the most practical day trips, while Seven Rila Lakes is more nature-focused but logistically harder.